



OUTLIERS

What You Store

Layer 3 of 8 · Recording what happened,
and letting everything else be worked out.

EST. MMXXVI · OUTLIERS ACCELERATOR

Facts, not descriptions

A description of a relationship starts going out of date the moment you write it. A record of something that happened never does.

WHAT THE LAST LAYER LEFT YOU WITH

Your records have a shape and your system can tell one person from another. But the fields you would naturally fill in, things like their job title or how warm the relationship is, are claims about a moving world. Nobody has to touch them for them to become wrong.

WHAT THIS LAYER BUILDS

This layer changes what you keep. Instead of writing down what is true about someone today, your system records what *happened*, one line at a time. Everything else, including when you last spoke and where the relationship stands, is worked out from those lines whenever you ask.

WRITTEN BY HAND

last spoke: recently

relationship: warm

job title: Head of Ops

true on the day you typed it

RECORDED AS IT HAPPENED



NOBODY TYPES THE RIGHT-HAND BOX. IT IS CALCULATED.

How it works

Three rules, and they are all consequences of the first.

1. ONLY ADD. NEVER EDIT

Things that happened go into a list, one line each, and nothing already in that list is ever changed or removed. If you got something wrong, you add a correction; you do not go back and alter history. That means the record of your relationships cannot quietly shift under you, which is exactly what makes it worth trusting.

2. A SHORT, FIXED LIST OF WHAT COUNTS AS SOMETHING HAPPENING

You wrote to them. They replied. A call was booked. You met. They changed jobs. They went quiet. Your system knows that list and refuses anything not on it, which stops this becoming another mess in six months. The installer asks what counts as contact in your line of work, because a site visit or a quote sent matters in some businesses and not others.

3. THE DESCRIPTIVE FIELDS ARE NOW CALCULATED, AND YOU STOP TYPING THEM

When you last spoke is the date of the most recent thing that happened. How many exchanges you have had is a count. Where the relationship stands follows rules you can read: a reply makes someone active, and a conversation that has gone quiet past a length of time you choose parks itself.

That last part matters more than it looks. Nobody has to decide to give up on a thread. It steps aside on its own, which means your list of live conversations stays honest without anybody being ruthless.

WHAT HAPPENS IF THERE IS NO HISTORY YET

Then your system says so, rather than guessing. Someone with nothing recorded against them is not cold, they are simply unobserved, and those are different things. A CRM that invents a status for someone it knows nothing about is a CRM that will lie to you later.

Build it

One command. It asks you a few questions so what you get is yours, then does the work.

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/outliers-crm-03-records
cd outliers-crm-03-records
python install.py
```

This layer needs Layers 1 and 2. It will check, and tell you if something is missing.

WHAT IT ASKS YOU, AND WHY

QUESTION	WHAT IT CHANGES
What counts as contact in your business?	A message, a call, a site visit, a quote sent, a session delivered. Your list, because a builder and a coach do not count the same things.
After how long is a quiet conversation over?	Thirty days suits most people. Whatever you choose, conversations older than that step aside on their own instead of sitting on your list making you feel guilty.

WHAT YOU END UP WITH

- A single history file that only ever gets added to.
- A tool that works out, from that history, when you last spoke to anyone and where things stand.
- A rule that quiet conversations park themselves, so nothing sits on your list forever.

Now use it

This one only pays off once Layer 4 is filling the history for you. Read what it will do, and come back to it.

If you brought in a contacts export at Layer 1, you can try the calculation now on the handful of people you have spoken to since. Otherwise there is genuinely nothing useful to do here yet, and this guide is not going to invent an exercise to fill the space.

What is worth doing is reading the state rules the installer wrote into your CRM, in **_layers/**. They are three short paragraphs in plain English, and they are the rules your system will use to decide what is live and what has gone quiet, for as long as you run it. If you disagree with any of them, change them now while it costs nothing.

IF YOU ALREADY HAD SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Your test: ask your existing system who you have not spoken to in sixty days. If the answer comes from a field somebody typed, it is a guess. If you cannot get an answer at all, this layer is the one you are missing.

WHAT THIS LAYER LEAVES UNSOLVED

A history is only as good as what reaches it, and right now the only thing that could put anything in it is you, typing. That is the admin that kills CRMs, so putting it back in at this point would undo the whole point of the exercise.

NEXT: LAYER 4 • CAPTURE

Your system starts filling its own history from the places your conversations already happen. This is where the typing stops and the thing starts giving back.

WORDS USED IN THIS GUIDE

Event	A record that something happened, with a date and where it came from.
Append-only	A file that only ever has lines added. Nothing already written is changed.
Calculated field	Something worked out from your history rather than typed in.
Parked	A conversation that has gone quiet and stepped aside on its own.